

Which of these stories do you tell yourself today? Check all that apply, then write in your own.

☐ I'm not good at math.

☐ I'm not lucky with money.

☐ It's not so bad being in debt . . . at least I'm not as bad as others.

☐ I'm scared of losing money.

☐ Investing feels like gambling.

The Stories We Tell about Ourselves

When I was younger, I used to jokingly call myself a “skinny Indian guy.” Looking back, I wish I hadn’t used that kind of negative self-description. Yes, I was skinny, but after repeating that phrase over and over, it became a self-fulfilling prophecy. I was actually saying, “I’m skinny and there’s nothing I can do about it.” When I finally decided to change and start learning how to work out properly, it took me a lot more time because I had to not only change my knowledge of nutrition and fitness—but also my identity itself. (And identity is very, very hard to change.)

Here’s what I wish someone had told me: That’s just a story you’re telling yourself. If you want to change the story, start by changing the words you use.

So, starting today, what words could you use to encourage, not demean, yourself?